

Calvin Nel

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Senior Technical Lead | Software Architect | .NET & Distributed Systems

Cape Town, South Africa

South African Citizen | British Citizen

Professional Summary

Senior Technical Lead with 15+ years of experience designing and delivering scalable software solutions across fintech, media and enterprise environments.

I specialise in modernising legacy systems, reducing technical debt and leading engineering teams through complex technical delivery. My focus is on building maintainable software that enables teams to deliver features quickly without sacrificing long-term quality.

I enjoy solving difficult engineering problems, mentoring developers and designing systems that are simple, reliable and built to evolve.

Career Snapshot

- 20+ years in IT
 - 15+ years in professional software development
 - Technical Lead since 2022
 - Extensive fintech and payment platform experience
 - Backend architecture and distributed systems
 - 200+ production deployments orchestrated at a single fintech platform
 - South African & British Citizen
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Career History

Company	Position	Period
PayFast	Senior Lead Developer	Aug 2022 – Present
24.com (Media24)	Senior Software Developer	Oct 2019 – Jul 2022
OrderIn	Senior Software Developer	Jan 2019 – Sep 2019
CSG International	Senior Software Developer	Jun 2017 – Dec 2018
RCS	Senior Software Developer	Dec 2015 – May 2017
Alacrity	Analyst Developer	Mar 2011 – Nov 2015
Khusela Solutions	Intermediate Support Technician	Apr 2010 – Mar 2011
Parker Hannifin (UK)	Intermediate IT Technician	Apr 2009 – Nov 2009
Storeys:SSP (UK)	IT Technician	Aug 2004 – Apr 2009

Core Competencies

- Technical Leadership
 - Software Architecture
 - Backend Engineering
 - Distributed Systems
 - API Design & Integration
 - Payment Platforms
 - Legacy System Modernisation
 - Performance Optimisation
 - Technical Debt Reduction
 - DevOps Collaboration
 - Agile Delivery
 - Mentoring & Coaching
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Technical Skills

Frameworks

- .NET Framework 4.0–4.8
- .NET 5–10
- ASP.NET MVC 3-5
- ASP.NET Core MVC 5-10 + preview 11
- Entity Framework (EF) 4–6
- EF Core 5–9
- SignalR

Databases

- MS SQL Server
- MySQL / MariaDB
- Oracle
- Redis (distributed caching)

Frontend

- Vue.js 2/3
- JavaScript
- Angular
- HTML / CSS
- Legacy: jQuery, Knockout.js

Cloud & DevOps

- Azure
- Azure DevOps
- Docker
- Kubernetes (Rancher)
- GitHub
- CI/CD
- AWS

Architecture & Design

- REST APIs
 - Distributed Systems
 - Domain Driven Design (DDD)
 - Microservices
 - Event-Driven Architecture
 - SOLID Principles
 - Object-Oriented Design
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Professional Experience

Senior Lead Developer

PayFast

August 2022 – Present

Overview Technical Lead responsible for PayFast's EFT platforms, including SID, USSD and the wider EFT ecosystem.

Joined as a Senior Developer and immediately assumed Team Lead responsibilities following the departure of the existing lead. Since then, I have been responsible for technical direction, solution architecture, engineering standards and successful delivery across multiple payment products.

Responsibilities

- Lead the EFT engineering team.
- Drive technical architecture and solution design.
- Own sprint planning and technical delivery.
- Perform code reviews and maintain engineering standards.
- Mentor developers and support technical growth.
- Manage production deployments.
- Prepare Change Requests (CR) and Deployment Requests (DR).
- Collaborate with product owners, business stakeholders and engineering teams.

Key Achievements

- Led delivery of the Capitec Pay integration.
- Delivered Nedbank Direct alongside multiple concurrent initiatives.
- Delivered the Absa Pay integration.
- Drove rigorous code review and enforced testing discipline on all changes, removing the need for a dedicated QA function and delivering 200+ production deployments with virtually zero rollbacks and no downtime.
- Preserved backward compatibility of API contracts across the service dependency chain, enabling independent, zero-downtime deployments rather than coordinated lockstep releases.
- Resolved a critical SignalR information leakage issue.
- Improved performance across multiple high-volume payment workflows.
- Led architecture across multiple overlapping EFT systems.
- Adopted AI-assisted development tooling (Copilot, Cursor, Kiro) to reduce boilerplate and accelerate delivery, while maintaining rigorous human review so AI augments rather than replaces engineering judgement.

Technologies

- .NET Framework 4.7.2
 - .NET Core / .NET 5-8
 - SignalR
 - SQL Server
 - Redis
 - Vue.js 2
 - Kubernetes (Rancher)
 - REST APIs
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Senior Software Developer

24.com (Media24)

October 2019 – July 2022

Highlights

- Member of the Core Engineering team.
 - Modernised legacy applications into .NET Core APIs.
 - Applied Domain Driven Design (DDD) principles and contributed to a microservices architecture.
 - Developed and maintained backend services supporting high-traffic digital platforms.
 - Worked with Azure cloud services and Microsoft Azure DevOps for source control, work management and CI/CD.
 - Collaborated with cross-functional teams using Agile delivery practices.
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Senior Software Developer

OrderIn

January 2019 – September 2019

Highlights

- Worked across React, .NET MVC and ASP.NET Core services.
 - Assisted migration towards microservices architecture.
 - Implemented IdentityServer4 authentication and authorisation.
 - Worked with AWS-hosted containerised services.
 - Developed backend APIs supporting multiple applications.
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Senior Software Development Engineer

CSG International

June 2017 – December 2018

Highlights

- Developed enterprise applications using C#, VB.NET, SQL Server and Oracle.
- Optimised application and database performance.
- Performed code reviews and mentored developers.
- Shared engineering knowledge and best practices.

- Collaborated with international engineering teams.
 - Delivered GDPR-related platform improvements.
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Senior Database / Software Developer

RCS

December 2015 – May 2017

Highlights

- Sole developer responsible for major financial integration projects.
 - Designed and built the Smart Credit integration platform.
 - Delivered the Cash Advance platform.
 - Owned the full software lifecycle from architecture through production support.
 - Worked closely with retail and financial partners.
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Analyst Developer

Alacrity

March 2011 – November 2015

Highlights

- Delivered enterprise software for clients including Old Mutual, Bridgestone, I&J, IDS and WyzeTalk.
 - Worked directly with customers on solution design.
 - Participated in planning, architecture and implementation.
 - Developed full-stack solutions across the Microsoft technology stack.
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Education

Foundation Degree

ICT System Support

University of Northumbria

United Kingdom

Professional Development

Completed courses including:

- Software Architecture & Security
 - ASP.NET Core API Development
 - Blazor Development
 - RabbitMQ Microservices
 - Design Patterns in C#
 - Software Architecture Fundamentals
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Engineering Philosophy

- Build maintainable software before clever software.
 - Reduce technical debt continuously.
 - Optimise systems using evidence rather than assumptions.
 - Design systems that are easy to evolve.
 - Mentor engineers and improve team capability.
 - Automate repetitive work wherever practical.
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Professional Interests

I enjoy keeping up with developments across the .NET ecosystem and regularly explore new technologies and engineering practices to improve software quality and developer productivity.

Current areas of interest include:

- AI-assisted development tooling (Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Kiro)
 - Native AOT
 - Distributed systems
 - Performance optimisation
 - Modern API design
 - Open-source libraries
 - Benchmarking and profiling
 - Containerisation
 - Cloud-native development
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Contact

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